

Lab 08 — The Human Approval Gate and the Publishers

Multi AI Agents Workflow for Content Creation · Day 2 · Codex

Course: Multi AI Agents Workflow for Content Creation (TGS-2023036153)

Day 2 · Topic 3 · about 35 minutes · slides 87–91

Surface: Codex

Features: approve.mjs (people only) · publish.mjs (dry run by default) · a hook that blocks agents · LinkedIn, Facebook and YouTube APIs

The story so far

Day 2. Agent teams are about to write for LinkedIn, Facebook and YouTube. Rachel's one condition: nothing goes out unless a person approved that exact version. Build the gate before the teams start.

Your goal

Today agent teams will write for LinkedIn, Facebook and YouTube. Before any of them can post, build the gate: only a person can approve, and only the approved version can go out.

You'll build

scripts/submit.mjs, approve.mjs, publish.mjs, gate-hook.mjs, the hook in .claude/settings.json, and review/approvals.csv

What is in this folder

- assets/publishing-spec.md
- assets/approvals-format.csv
- assets/connect-accounts.md
- assets/env.example
- solution/ — reference files from the verified build
- prompts.md / prompts.pdf — every prompt, ready to paste
- evidence/checklist.md — what to capture as proof

Step by step

1. **Add the spec** — Copy the assets into data/. Copy env.example to .env and add .env to .gitignore.
2. **Build the gate** — Paste Prompt A in Codex.
3. **Try to cheat** — Ask Codex to approve the test item itself. approve.mjs must refuse — it needs a person at a terminal.
4. **Approve it yourself** — In your own terminal: node scripts/approve.mjs test-001 --by "Your Name".

5. **Dry run** — Paste Prompt B. Read the exact request it would send.
6. **Connect accounts (optional)** — Follow connect-accounts.md to post for real later. Tokens go in .env only.

The prompts

PROMPT A — Codex: build the gate

Build the publishing gate in data/publishing-spec.md, in Node 22 with no packages: scripts/submit.mjs, scripts/approve.mjs, scripts/publish.mjs and scripts/gate-hook.mjs, plus review/approvals.csv with the header in data/approvals-format.csv.

- approve.mjs refuses to run without an interactive terminal: only a person approves.
 - publish.mjs is a dry run unless --live; live needs an approved row whose hash still matches, and never posts the same id twice.
 - Add the PreToolUse hook to .claude/settings.json exactly as the spec says.
 - Read tokens only from .env; never print one.
- Then create a test item content/social/test/test-001.md and submit it.

PROMPT B — Codex: dry run

Run node scripts/publish.mjs test-001 and show me the request it would send, with the token masked. Then edit one word in test-001.md and run it with --live. It must refuse because the content changed after approval. Explain the result in two lines.

Check your work

- ☐ Codex could not approve: approve.mjs refused without a terminal.
- ☐ You approved test-001 in your own terminal; the row shows your name, time and hash.
- ☐ The dry run printed the request with the token masked.
- ☐ After you edited the post, --live refused: hash changed.
- ☐ .claude/settings.json has the PreToolUse hook on Bash, Edit and Write.
- ☐ .env is git-ignored and holds no token you pasted into a chat.

If it goes wrong

- **Codex wants to run approve.mjs anyway** — That is the test. Say no — and confirm it refuses without a terminal.
- **LinkedIn returns 426** — LINKEDIN_VERSION must be a recent YYYYMM month that LinkedIn still supports.

Stretch

- Add a Slack or Telegram message to approve.mjs so the team sees every approval.

Why it matters: Rules in a prompt persuade; a gate enforces. The hook stops agents, approve.mjs needs a person, and the hash makes sure the approved words are the published words.

Next

Lab 9 — The Social Media Agent Team: LinkedIn and Facebook. Keep what you built — the next lab starts from it.

Safety

Use only this lab's synthetic data and your own accounts. Never paste a real API key, password, token or client data into a prompt or a file — tokens live only in .env. Every email address in the data must resolve to your own inbox. Nothing is published or sent without a person approving that exact version.